

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with a year of practical experience at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner across international arbitration and real estate disputes, plus ongoing client-facing legal advisory work at Citizens Advice East Berkshire. Experienced in document review, electronic bundling, case-file management, deadline tracking, legal research, drafting procedural documents and client communication. Able to manage competing matters in a high-volume environment and to contribute to a team without a lengthy handover period.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**
Queen Mary University of London

- International arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction (75%)

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**
University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**
King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize: top 20 of a 200-student cohort, with partial funding toward the undergraduate degree

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**
Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the memorial; conducted legal research
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**
Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines; maintained matter records via iManage
- Prepared client notes and assisted with routine client communications

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead**July 2026 – Present****Legal Adviser**

- Manages matters from first client interview through to submission: takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, and maintains confidential case records to deadlines
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; researches complex points and identifies evidential gaps
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options; translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals across welfare, employment, housing and debt matters

Q-Legal · London**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; document review; electronic bundling; iManage; electronic court filing portals; case management and time-recording systems; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; concise report and correspondence writing

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters